

ACTIVITY – 1

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Visualization Evaluation for Data Analysis Scenarios

Objective: To evaluate different data visualizations for communicating workload, variability, distribution, trends, and decision-making insights across real-world application scenarios.

1. Hospital Patient Admission Analysis

A hospital has collected patient admission data across Cardiology, Neurology, Pediatrics, Orthopedics, and Emergency departments for one year. The main objective is to understand department workload, admission variability, and patient distribution.

Evaluation of Visualizations

Visualization	Evaluation and Evidence
Bar Chart	Best for directly comparing total admissions between departments. It clearly identifies departments with the highest and lowest workload.
Stacked Bar Chart	Useful when admissions are divided into categories such as months, age groups, or patient types. It shows both totals and composition, but can become difficult to compare individual segments.
Treemap	Provides a compact view of proportional patient distribution. It is visually attractive for showing contribution to total admissions, but exact comparisons are harder.
Box Plot	Best for analyzing variability in monthly admissions and detecting unusually high or low admission periods. It does not directly show total workload.
Histogram	Shows the frequency distribution of admission counts and helps identify skewness and common ranges, but is less effective for comparing departments directly.

Recommendation: A combination of a **bar chart** and **box plot** is most effective. The bar chart communicates department workload clearly, while the box plot reveals

variability and outliers. If only one visualization must be selected for executives, the bar chart is the clearest because workload comparison is the primary requirement.

Suggested Libraries: Python: Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly | R: ggplot2, dplyr

2. E-Commerce Customer Spending Behaviour

An online retailer has customer purchase amounts, order frequency, and product categories. The analysis aims to identify high-value customers, understand spending variability, and observe purchasing trends.

Evaluation of Visualizations

Visualization	Evaluation and Evidence
Histogram	Shows the distribution of purchase amounts and helps identify whether spending is concentrated among low-value customers or spread across different ranges.
Violin Plot	Combines distribution shape with summary statistics and is useful for comparing spending behaviour across product categories or customer groups.
Box Plot	Clearly identifies median spending, variability, and high-value outliers. It is particularly useful for spotting customers whose spending is much higher than the typical customer.
Density Plot	Provides a smooth representation of spending distributions and makes it easier to compare overlapping customer segments.
Bar Chart	Best for comparing total or average spending across product categories and showing purchasing trends at an aggregated level.

Recommendation: For business executives, a **box plot** is highly suitable for identifying high-value customers and spending variability, while a **bar chart** should complement it to communicate category-level purchasing trends. A dashboard combining both provides the strongest business insight.

Suggested Libraries: Python: Seaborn, Plotly Express | R: ggplot2

3. University Examination Performance Dashboard

A university wants to compare student marks across departments, identify score distributions, detect outliers, and recognize top-performing classes. The dashboard should support academic decision-making.

Evaluation of Visualizations

Visualization	Evaluation and Evidence
Bar Chart	Clearly compares average or median marks across departments and classes. It is easy for administrators and academic staff to interpret.
Box Plot	Shows median, score spread, and outliers for each department. It is one of the most effective charts for comparing examination performance distributions.
Histogram	Shows the overall frequency distribution of marks and helps identify whether scores are concentrated, normally distributed, or skewed.
Violin Plot	Provides detailed distribution shapes and allows comparison of score density across departments, although it may be less familiar to general users.
Scatter Plot	Can reveal relationships between marks and variables such as attendance or assignment scores when those variables are available.

Recommendation: The dashboard should primarily use **box plots** for departmental performance comparison and outlier detection, supported by **bar charts** for average scores and **histograms** for overall score distribution. Dashboard improvements should include filters for department, semester, and class; consistent scales; clear labels; and KPI cards for average score, pass percentage, and top-performing class.

Suggested Libraries: Python: Pandas, Seaborn, Plotly | R: ggplot2, plotly

4. Climate and Rainfall Distribution Study

Meteorological data contains monthly rainfall, temperature, and humidity for multiple cities. The objective is to represent seasonal rainfall variation and climate distributions for environmental research.

Evaluation of Visualizations

Visualization	Evaluation and Evidence
Histogram	Shows the frequency distribution of rainfall or temperature values and helps identify common ranges and skewness.
Density Plot	Provides a smooth view of the distribution and is useful for comparing climate patterns between cities or seasons.
Box Plot	Effectively compares monthly or seasonal rainfall variability, identifies medians, spread, and extreme rainfall events.
Bar Chart	Clearly displays average monthly rainfall and makes seasonal patterns easy to communicate, although it does not show distribution or outliers as well as a box plot.

Recommendation: For environmental researchers, the **box plot** is the most suitable single visualization for comparing seasonal rainfall variation because it displays central tendency, variability, and extreme values. A **bar chart** should be added when the primary goal is to communicate average monthly rainfall trends. Density plots are valuable for detailed distribution comparisons between cities.

Suggested Libraries: Python: Matplotlib, Seaborn | R: ggplot2

5. Bank Loan Risk Assessment

A financial institution has customer loan amounts, repayment history, income levels, and credit scores. The analysis needs to show loan distributions and customer segments while highlighting risk patterns, skewness, and outliers for loan approval decisions.

Evaluation of Visualizations

Visualization	Evaluation and Evidence
Histogram	Useful for identifying skewness in loan amounts and income levels and understanding the frequency of different financial ranges.
Box Plot	Highlights outliers in loan amounts, income, and credit scores and provides a clear comparison of risk-related variables across customer groups.
Scatter Plot	Shows relationships such as income versus loan amount or credit score versus repayment performance. It can reveal clusters and potential risk patterns.
Bar Chart	Useful for comparing loan approval or default rates across customer segments, credit-score categories, or repayment groups.
Heatmap	Although not listed in the scenario, it can be valuable for showing correlations among income, loan amount, credit score, and repayment variables.

Recommendation: A **box plot** should be included in the management dashboard to highlight skewness, variability, and outliers in financial variables. It should be supported by a **scatter plot** for risk relationships and a **bar chart** for approval/default rates across customer segments. This combination provides both statistical and decision-oriented insights.

Suggested Libraries: Python: Seaborn, Plotly, Pandas | R: ggplot2

Overall Conclusion

The evaluation shows that no single visualization is ideal for every analytical purpose. Bar charts are strongest for straightforward category comparisons, box plots are highly effective for variability and outlier detection, histograms and density plots explain distributions, and scatter plots reveal relationships between variables. For decision-making dashboards, combining complementary visualizations is generally more effective than relying on a single chart. The final choice should depend on the audience, analytical objective, and the type of evidence required.